THE RISE OF NATIONALISM IN EUROPE

From the French Revolution to the Making of Nation-States

SORRIEU'S VISION (1848)

THE DREAM OF REPUBLICS

A world made of 'democratic and social Republics'.

STATUE OF LIBERTY

Peoples of Europe and America offering homage.

SHATTERED ABSOLUTISM

Remains of symbols of monarchical institutions.

THE PACT BETWEEN NATIONS

DEFINING THE NATION-STATE

"A NATION IS THE CULMINATION OF A LONG PAST OF ENDEAVORS, SACRIFICE, AND DEVOTION. ITS EXISTENCE IS A DAILY PLEBISCITE."

— ERNST RENAN, 1882

1789

THE FRENCH REVOLUTION

TRANSFER OF SOVEREIGNTY

From the absolute monarchy to a body of French citizens.

CITIZEN-LED DESTINY

The people constitute the nation and shape its future path.

MISSION TO LIBERATE

A destiny to help other European peoples become nations.

COLLECTIVE IDENTITY

REVOLUTIONARY MEASURES

LA PATRIE & LE CITOYEN

Emphasized a united community enjoying equal rights under a constitution.

THE NEW TRICOLOUR

Chosen to replace the former royal standard, symbolising the new nation.

NATIONAL ASSEMBLY

The Estates General was renamed and elected by the body of active citizens.

UNIFORM SYSTEMS

Standardized weights, measures, and French as the common national language.

NAPOLEONIC CODE 1804

CIVIL CODE PRINCIPLES

- Abolished all privileges based on birth.
- Established equality before the law.
- Secured the right to property.

ADMINISTRATIVE EFFICIENCY

- Simplified administrative divisions.
- Abolished the feudal system and serfdom.
- Improved transport and communication systems.

INITIAL ENTHUSIASM TURNED TO HOSTILITY DUE TO INCREASED TAXATION, CENSORSHIP, AND FORCED CONSCRIPTION.

THE MAKING OF NATIONALISM

LANDED ARISTOCRACY

The dominant social and political class on the continent.

United by a common way of life, owning vast estates and town-houses.

Spoke French for diplomacy and high society.

THE PEASANTRY

The majority of the European population.

In the West, mostly tenants and small owners.

In Central and Eastern Europe, land was cultivated by serfs on vast estates.

NEW MIDDLE CLASS

Emerged with the growth of industrial production and trade.

Comprised of industrialists, businessmen, and professionals.

Advocated for national unity and the abolition of aristocratic privileges.

POLITICAL LIBERALISM

INDIVIDUAL RIGHTS

Freedom for the individual and equality of all before the law.

GOVERNANCE

Concept of government by consent and end of autocracy.

CONSTITUTIONALISM

A representative government through parliament and private property rights.

ECONOMIC LIBERALISM

MARKET FREEDOM

Abolition of state-imposed restrictions on movement of goods.

THE ZOLLVEREIN (1834)

A customs union formed by Prussia to abolish tariff barriers.

UNIFICATION

Created a unified economic territory across German states.

THE AGE OF REVOLUTIONS

1830

JULY REVOLUTION IN FRANCE

Sparked constitutional changes and inspired uprisings across Europe, including Belgium's independence from the Netherlands.

1832

GREEK INDEPENDENCE

The Treaty of Constantinople recognized Greece as an independent nation after a long struggle against the Ottoman Empire.

1848

REVOLUTION OF THE LIBERALS

Demands for constitutionalism and national unification. The Frankfurt Parliament attempted to draft a German constitution.

GERMANY 1871

BLOOD AND IRON

- Led by Otto von Bismarck and the Prussian army.
- Three wars over seven years against Austria, Denmark, France.
- Proclamation of the German Empire at Versailles.

ITALY 1861

RISORGIMENTO

- Key figures: Mazzini, Cavour, and Garibaldi.
- Victor Emmanuel II proclaimed King of United Italy.
- Rome finally joined the unified state in 1870.

NATIONALISM & IMPERIALISM

THE BALKAN CRISIS

- Region of intense ethnic variation under Ottoman control.
- Spread of romantic nationalism led to explosive independence struggles.
- Big Power rivalry (Russia, Germany, Britain) over trade and territory.

THE ROAD TO WORLD WAR I

1871 — 1914

Nationalism, aligned with imperialism, led Europe to disaster in 1914.

GLOBAL IMPACT

UNIVERSAL MODEL

The 'nation-state' became accepted as the natural and universal form of political organization.

ANTI-IMPERIALISM

Nationalist movements worldwide were inspired by the struggle for independence from colonial rule.

COLLECTIVE UNITY

A sense of national identity, forged in confrontation with imperialism, transformed global politics.